

Advanced PHP

Let's go through some of the advanced features of PHP like Date, Secure E-mail, Include, E-mail, Error, PHP Filter and PHP Exception:

10.1. Date

In PHP the `date()` function is used to format a timestamp or a date. It arranges a timestamp into a readable date and time. Using the `date/` time functions, you can format date and time on the server. However, these functions entirely depend on the server settings. Here you can use the syntax, `date (format, timestamp)`. Look at the table below:

Parameter	Description
Format	This parameter is essential. It assigns the timestamp format.
Timestamp	This Parameter is optional. This takes the Date or/and time that you want to format. If no value is provided then the current time is used for formatting.

In PHP, timestamp is the number of seconds since January 1, 1970 at 00:00:00. This is also termed as, 'Unix Timestamp'.

In the `date` function, the first parameter specifies about formatting date and time. Several letters are used to represent date and time formats. Some commonly used letters are given below:

- `d` - Represents day of a month (01-31)
- `D` - Represents day in three letter text format
- `m` - Represents month, as a number (01-12)
- `M` - Represents month in three letter text format
- `Y` - Represents year in four digits
- `y` - Represents year in two digits

Some other frequently used characters are `"/"`, `"."`, or `"-"` etc. Basically, these characters are inserted between letters to add additional formatting. Look at the code below: